



#### 1. RESEARCH

Get to know your customers, product, market area, and competitors.

**“Email marketing has the highest return on investment for small businesses.”**

Campaign Monitor, 2019



#### 2. CUSTOMIZE

Adapt your product, price, and distribution to suit your customers' needs and your market.



#### 3. MARKET

Create and communicate your message to your intended customers to interest and attract them.



#### 4. SELL

Close the sale with your customer, ensuring the process is hassle-free.

### TRACKING SALES

Looking at overall sales may not provide all the information necessary for you to make the best marketing decisions. Here are some ways to look at sales from different perspectives; they will help determine the best areas in which to invest marketing funds.

- › **Keep records** for each day, week, month, quarter, and year, and compare with previous time periods.
- › **Break figures down** to understand the bestselling products or services.
- › **Identify which customers** make the most/largest purchases.
- › **Record sales** made to new and existing customers—look out for repeat purchases.
- › **Identify and compare** the best sales channels, such as face-to-face retail or online transactions.

### ANALYZING SALES DATA

As a business owner, you can collect sales data from many different sources (see pp.154–155). However, in order for it to provide meaningful information, it needs to be organized and analyzed. For example, data such as a list of customers who bought a particular item does not reveal anything, but when organized by source, it could reveal that most sales were made to new customers. Use simple spreadsheets to analyze data.